

Nearby Vibes

Design Brief — for visual design execution (Claude Design)

Companion to: Nearby Vibes MVP PRD v1.8 · Scope: Look and visual style only — see PRD for behavior · Prepared for: Visual design execution · July 23, 2026

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How to use this brief

This is a condensed, design-only extract of the full **Nearby Vibes MVP PRD (v1.8)** — specifically its screen inventory, UI specifications, and visual design direction. It leaves out everything a designer doesn't need: API contracts, data models, security internals, notification engine internals, deployment. Attach *this* document to a design session rather than the full PRD — it's the same information at a fraction of the length, without the noise.

One rule governs the relationship between the two documents: **this brief governs look; the full PRD governs behavior**. If a screen design conflicts with something the PRD specifies functionally (a required field, a character limit, a state a screen must support), the PRD wins and the design should be reconciled to it — not the other way around.

What's new in v1.4: the source PRD added a Subscription & Billing module (14-day trial, Free/Premium plans, a Founding Venue Program, Paddle checkout) and an expanded, separately authenticated Admin Panel. This brief includes design requirements for both — see §3 Screen inventory and §4.

What's new in v1.5: a venue owner can now invite exactly one team member or content creator per venue (a “seat”), choosing a role type — Venue Team Member or Social Content Creator — and a custom title before sending the invite. That person's dashboard access also expanded: they now see the venue's overall performance, not just their own posts. See the updated invite-screen and dashboard notes under §4.

What's new in v1.6: the team seat is now a Premium-tier capability — unavailable on the Free plan. The invite screen needs a locked state explaining that Trial or Premium is required, and the dashboard needs a suspended state for a venue that already has a seat filled but has lapsed to Free. See the updated **Team seat invite** and **Venue dashboard** notes under §4.

What's new in v1.7–v1.8: a new anti-fraud rule prevents a venue from farming repeat free trials by deleting and re-claiming the same physical location. This surfaces in two places designers need to account for: the **Venue claim search** screen gains a distinct “this venue can't be re-claimed yet” state (separate from the existing “already registered” error), and the post-claim welcome moment needs a variant for venues that land straight on the Free plan rather than a trial. See the new **Venue claim search** subsection and the updated **Venue profile setup** note under §4.

1. What Nearby Vibes is (context for tone)

Nearby Vibes is a location-based Progressive Web App: hospitality venues (bars, restaurants) post time-boxed food and drink specials, and people within about 0.75 miles discover them, navigate to the venue, and redeem them. The design should feel like a *social-native, in-the-moment discovery tool* — closer to Stories/Reels-style immediacy than a static listings directory.

Three audiences now see meaningfully different surfaces:

- **The nearby user** (browsing Tile/Map View, opening posts, following venues) — this is the bulk of the visual design surface, and it's mobile-first, fast-moving, FOMO-driven.
- **The venue owner / social media manager** (posting specials, reading their dashboard, and — new — managing their subscription) — this surface should feel calmer and more utilitarian than the consumer-facing side; it's a work tool, not a discovery feed. The subscription/pricing surface specifically should feel trustworthy and transparent rather than salesy.
- **The Admin (internal, Nearby Vibes staff)** (*new emphasis, v1.4*) — a purely internal operations surface, reached through a separate, non-public login. This should be the plainest of the three: dense, functional, and unconcerned with consumer brand polish. Design effort here should go toward information density and clarity of destructive actions (delete, remove), not visual flourish.

2. Visual direction (confirmed)

Move away from the existing reference Figma file (Nearby Vibes Claude) — it reads as dated and basic. The new direction is more visual, more image-forward, with cleaner lines: closer to a contemporary consumer app. This direction applies to the **user- and venue-facing surfaces**; the Admin portal (§4, new) is explicitly exempt from needing to carry the full consumer brand system — see that section for what it should look like instead.

Reference sites (direction, not literal templates)

Reference	What to take from it
on.com zillow.com	Clean lines, minimalist layout, generous whitespace How to present a large volume of location-based cards/listings without feeling cluttered — directly relevant to Tile View and Map View at scale
alltrails.com	Overall app layout pattern — map-plus-list navigation, card structure
nps.gov digital apps	Visual tone — illustrative, high-contrast, confidently graphic

Brand color palette (confirmed hex values)

Swatch	Hex	Suggested role (yours to finalize)
Bright mint/teal	#25EFB8	Primary accent — active-special highlights, primary CTAs
Vibrant magenta	#F814E8	Secondary accent — drink-special category color, high-energy states (e.g., countdown urgency)
Violet/purple	#7F53F3	Tertiary accent — food-special category color, secondary interactive states
Black	#000000	Primary text, high-contrast surfaces
White	#FFFFFF	Base background

Contrast constraint — non-negotiable: the PWA must meet WCAG 2.1 AA. #25EFB8, #F814E8, and #7F53F3 are all bright/light enough that they will likely fail the 4.5:1 text-contrast ratio used as text-on-white or as body text generally. Treat them as accent/badge/button/illustration colors, not body-text colors, and check actual contrast ratios once applied to real screens.

Admin portal palette note (*new*, v1.4): the Admin portal may use a reduced, purely functional palette (e.g., black/white/greyscale plus a single status-color set for success/warning/error) rather than the full consumer brand palette above. It should not attempt to look like a marketing surface — see §4's Admin subsections.

3. Screen inventory

Screen	Primary audience	Key states to design
Home — Tile View	User	Default results, fuzzy-location, empty-radius, age-gated (blurred) drink tiles present alongside normal food tiles
Home — Map View	User	Default, clustered markers, zoomed-out, marker tapped (preview → full)
Onboarding (permissions)	User	Notification prompt, location prompt, both-granted, both-denied
Post detail (full)	User	Image, video (paused/playing), age-gated (locked), expired-redirect
Venue profile	User	Standard, no-active-special
Account type selector	User/Venue	Personal vs. Business
Signup / Login	User/Venue	Social, email, error states (bad domain, weak password, unverified)
Venue claim search (<i>cooldown state, v1.7</i>)	Venue	Search, map-confirm, already-claimed error, re-claim cooldown error (distinct from already-claimed), no-results
Venue profile setup	Venue	Incomplete (blocks first post), complete, welcome-to-trial vs. welcome-to-Free-plan variant (new, v1.8)
Post creation wizard	Venue/Social Manager	Type select → fields → media upload/crop → disclaimer (drink) → preview → schedule/publish
Post management list	Venue/Social Manager	Draft, Scheduled, Active, Archived filters
Team seat invite (<i>updated, v1.5; Premium-gated, v1.6</i>)	Venue	No-seat/available, role-type (Venue Team Member vs. Social Content Creator) + title selection, pending invite, accepted, revoked, seat-filled (invite blocked), Free-plan locked (upgrade required), seat suspended (venue downgraded to Free)

Screen	Primary audience	Key states to design
Venue dashboard	Venue/Social Manager	Standard (headline metric + 5 visuals), Team-seat-scoped (expanded, v1.5: venue overall performance + own post detail — Premium-gated, v1.6), Free-plan upgrade prompt
Subscription / Pricing panel (<i>new</i>)	Venue	Trial-countdown active, Founding Venue eligible, Founding Venue cap-reached, Monthly/Annual comparison, promo-code entry/applied
Checkout (<i>new</i>)	Venue	Plan + platform-fee line-item summary, processing, success, declined/error
QR landing	User	Location-prompt-first, exact-match (special-live / no-live-special), nearby-fallback list, out-of-range, multi-venue disambiguation
Admin console	Admin (internal)	Report queue (now with inline actions), venue fraud queue, network dashboard (incl. subscription health)
Admin portal login (<i>new</i>)	Admin (internal)	Credential entry, TOTP entry, locked-out
Admin account management (<i>new</i>)	Admin (internal)	Users list/edit/delete, Venues list/edit/delete, Posts list/edit/delete
Admin onboarding queue (<i>new</i>)	Admin (internal)	New NYC-venue alert list
Static pages	All	About / For Users / For Businesses / Terms / Privacy / AUP / Contact
PWA install prompt	User	Bottom banner, device-specific instructions
Cookie consent banner	All	First-visit, manage-preferences expanded

4. Per-screen design requirements

Home — Tile View

Single-column, vertically scrolling card list on mobile; responsive multi-column grid at ≥ 768 px. Each tile is **one hero-image container** — no internal grids or stacked sections — showing (overlaid or stacked, your call): hero image, headline, price/% off, venue name + address, distance badge, and a **live decaying countdown timer** (should visually communicate urgency as time runs low, e.g., a shrinking bar or color shift). Drink-special tiles render **blurred** with an inline age-gate badge/overlay — never a full-screen block — sitting in the same list as normal food tiles.

Home — Map View

Full-viewport map, floating header banner (“X live specials near you”). Three marker states: active drink (cocktail icon), active food (food icon), no active post (neutral/greyed, still visible). Tap once → compact preview card (image, title, venue, address, time remaining); tap again → full post. Street/satellite toggle, “recenter to me” control. No oversized preview cards.

Onboarding

Two sequential, dismissible prompts (notification, then location), each explaining why before the native OS permission dialog fires. If both denied, straight into Tile View in its fuzzy/no-push state — never a hard block.

Age gate

Lightweight in-context overlay on the blurred tile/post, not a full-screen interstitial. Copy is jurisdiction-aware (21+ US / 18+ elsewhere), with Confirm / Not Now actions.

Venue claim search & claim outcome (*cooldown + welcome states, v1.7–v1.8*)

Two error states now need to read as clearly different problems, not one generic “can’t claim this” message:

- **Already registered** (existing): another account currently holds this venue. Framing: this venue is taken — search for a different one or contact support if you believe this is wrong.
- **Re-claim cooldown** (*new*): this venue was claimed before, that claim was removed, and it isn’t eligible to be re-claimed yet. Framing should be calm and informative rather than accusatory — most people hitting this aren’t the ones gaming the system. Something like “This venue was recently deactivated and can’t be re-claimed right now. Check back later, or contact support if you’re the new owner.” Avoid surfacing the exact cooldown mechanics (day counts, “fraud prevention”) — that’s internal reasoning, not user-facing copy.

Claim outcome — welcome variant: immediately after a successful claim, the venue sees either “Welcome — your 14-day free trial has started” (first-ever claim of this location) or, less commonly, a plainer “You’re on the Free plan” welcome (a location re-claimed after already using its one trial, §10.11/§10.16 of the PRD). The second variant should

still feel like a welcome, not a downgrade notice — this may be someone’s first time using the product even if the *venue* isn’t new to the platform. Both variants can route into the same profile-setup flow.

Post creation wizard

Six steps: Type (Drink/Food) → Core fields → Media (hero image required + optional secondary image/video) → Compliance (Drink only — disclaimer shown read-only) → Preview (exact render, tile + full) → Schedule/Publish. Design should make each step feel fast — this is a work tool for a time-poor venue owner, not a showcase.

Content lengths the layout must accommodate: title ≤60 characters, hook ≤120 characters, description ≤500 characters, optional conditions text ≤100 characters. Design hero cards and full-post layouts against realistic near-max-length copy, not just short placeholder text.

Venue dashboard

One headline metric — “Customers Brought In” — rendered larger/bolder than everything else on the page. Below it, exactly five supporting visuals, no more: Post Views Over Time (line chart), Push Performance (funnel: Sent → Open → Visit), Post Engagement (bar chart: views/shares/nav clicks), Visits from Posts (conversion chart), and a Post Performance Card. This should feel calm and legible, not like an analytics-tool wall of charts.

Updated, v1.5 — Team seat view: the invited team member/content creator now sees the *same* headline metric and four network-level charts the owner sees, **plus** their own Post Performance Card — this is an expansion from the earlier “own posts only” restriction. Design this as the identical dashboard layout the owner gets, with the Post Performance Card automatically scoped to the logged-in seat-holder’s own posts (no picker needed, since a venue has at most one seat). No billing/subscription visibility for this role.

New, v1.6 — Seat suspended state: if the team-seat holder logs in while their venue is on the Free plan (trial expired or subscription lapsed without the seat itself being revoked), they should see a locked/suspended message rather than a blank or broken dashboard — something like “Team access is paused while this venue is on the Free plan. Ask the owner to upgrade to restore your access.” This is a different message from the owner’s own Free-plan upgrade prompt below, since the seat-holder can’t act on it directly (only the owner can upgrade) — don’t give them a button that leads to a checkout screen they can’t use.

New, v1.4 — Free-plan state: when a venue’s subscription has lapsed to the Free plan, the dashboard route should render an upgrade prompt in place of the charts — not a bare error page. This should reuse the Subscription/Pricing panel’s visual language (below) rather than looking like a broken page: a short, benefit-oriented message (“See your customers brought in — upgrade to Premium”) plus a single clear button into the Pricing panel.

Team seat invite (*new, v1.5; Premium-gated, v1.6*)

A short, GitHub-style invite flow rather than a settings sub-page: the owner enters an email, picks a role type — **Venue Team Member** or **Social Content Creator** — via a simple two-option selector (these should read as organizational labels, not tiers — avoid implying one is “better” than the other), and optionally sets a custom title text field (e.g., “Weekend Creator”). Since a venue may only have one active seat, the screen should clearly communicate a “seat filled” state (showing who holds it, with revoke/replace actions) rather than simply disabling the invite button with no explanation.

Free-plan locked state: a venue on the Free plan cannot send an invite at all — this screen should present this as an upsell moment, not a dead end: explain that team seats are a Trial/Premium feature and link straight into the Subscription/Pricing panel (§4, below), reusing that panel’s visual language rather than a generic disabled-form look.

Seat suspended state: if a seat was already filled and the venue’s subscription lapses to Free, don’t remove the seat-holder from the screen — show them still listed (name, role, title) but visually marked as suspended/paused, with copy explaining that their access is paused until the venue upgrades again, and that the owner doesn’t need to re-invite them. This reinforces that suspension is temporary and reversible, distinct from a revoke.

Subscription / Pricing panel (*new, v1.4*)

Reached from the global footer (“Pricing”) at any time, and surfaced contextually at trial milestones (day 7, day 12, day 14) and from the Free-plan dashboard prompt above. This is a **conversion surface for a work tool**, not a marketing landing page — favor clarity and trustworthiness over hype.

Required elements:

- Current status: if in trial, a visible countdown (“9 days left in your trial”) rather than a buried date; if on Free or Premium, the current plan stated plainly.
- A Monthly (\$39/mo) vs. Annual (\$390/yr) comparison, with the annual discount (~17%, “2 months free” framing) visually called out but not overstated.
- The **Founding Venue Program** panel, shown only while eligible and the cap is unreached: this should read as a genuine, time-limited program, not a discount coupon — a short badge/callout format works well (“Founding Venue Program — 47 of 50 Manhattan spots remaining”) with its benefit list (50% off first year, Founding Venue badge, priority support, early feature access, roadmap input) legible at a glance, not buried in fine print.
- A promo-code entry field, low-emphasis (a text link like “Have a code?” that reveals an input), not a prominent form element competing with the main plan choice.
- Feature comparison should reference the same Premium feature list used in the dashboard/analytics screens (analytics dashboard, QR scan analytics, follower growth, Soft → Active conversion, post performance, push analytics, venue insights) so a venue owner can connect the price to something they’ve already seen has value.

Checkout (*new, v1.4*)

A short, single-purpose screen — this is not the place to introduce new visual patterns. Show a clear line-item breakdown: plan price, platform service fee (labeled plainly, e.g., “Payment processing fee”), and total, before the venue commits to Paddle’s payment step. A Paddle trust mark/badge is appropriate here to reassure the venue this is a legitimate, PCI-compliant checkout. Success and declined/error states should be simple and should not require the venue to re-select their plan if payment fails — only to retry the payment step.

QR landing

No venue context until geofence resolves one. Five states: location-off prompt; “You’re at [Venue Name]” (exact match, live special or “no live specials” banner); “You’re near Nearby Vibes — find specials near you” (30–100m fallback, shows a venue list, not one venue); silent hand-off to standard Home (>100m); “Which venue are you at?” disambiguation list (rare, dense-area overlap case).

Media / post canvas

Primary canvas is **1080×1920px, 9:16 vertical** — designed to feel like Stories/Reels/TikTok, not a traditional web card. Important content must stay within the **center 80% vertical safe zone** to avoid overlap with buttons/venue-info/captions. One hero image + optionally one more image or one ≤15-second video — never a grid, never stacked media, never autoplay (manual tap to play, shown as a swipeable slide).

Admin portal login (*new, v1.4*)

This screen should look **nothing like the consumer marketing/product surface** — no hero imagery, no brand color washes, minimal decoration. Treat it like an internal ops tool: a centered, plain form (business email + password), followed by a second-step TOTP code entry screen. A locked-out state should be equally plain, stating a cooldown timer without indicating whether the password or the code was the failing factor (this is a security requirement from the PRD, not just a design preference — see PRD §18.3/REQ-ADMIN-013). This screen is deliberately unbranded enough that a screenshot of it, out of context, would not obviously identify the product.

Admin account management & onboarding queue (*new*, v1.4)

Dense, table-first layouts for three entities — Users, Venues, Posts — each a searchable/filterable list with inline edit and delete actions. Favor data density and scanability (think an internal admin-dashboard/back-office aesthetic — plain tables, monospace-friendly IDs, clear status badges) over the card-based, image-forward language used on the consumer side. A separate Onboarding Queue view lists newly completed NYC venues chronologically with a one-click link into the venue record. The existing report queue gains inline view/edit/delete actions directly on each row — a reviewer should be able to act on a report without leaving the list view.

Footer / cookie banner / install prompt

Standard, low-emphasis global components: footer with copyright, legal links, location toggle, manual install trigger, and — *new* — a **Pricing** link; bottom-anchored cookie banner (Accept/Reject/Manage Preferences); bottom-banner PWA install prompt with device-specific instructions once accepted.

5. Accessibility constraints (apply to every screen)

- WCAG 2.1 AA color contrast, visible focus states, full keyboard navigability — including map controls, the multi-step post wizard, and — new — the subscription/checkout flow and the Admin portal.
- Every non-decorative image (hero images, state-conveying icons) needs alt text; venue-uploaded hero images should prompt for optional alt text at upload.
- Auto-updating content (countdown timers, trial-countdown on the Pricing panel) needs to work with assistive tech (ARIA live regions) without being verbose/disruptive when read aloud.
- The Admin portal, despite its plainer visual treatment, is still subject to the same WCAG 2.1 AA bar — “un-branded” does not mean “inaccessible.”

6. What this brief deliberately leaves out

Anything about *why* a screen behaves the way it does, API shapes, database fields, push notification bundling logic, Paddle webhook handling, security internals, or deployment — that’s all in the full PRD (§10–§21) and isn’t needed to execute the visual design. If a question comes up that this brief doesn’t answer (e.g., “what exactly triggers the Founding Venue cap to close,” or “what happens if a Paddle payment fails”), that’s the signal to check the full PRD rather than guess.